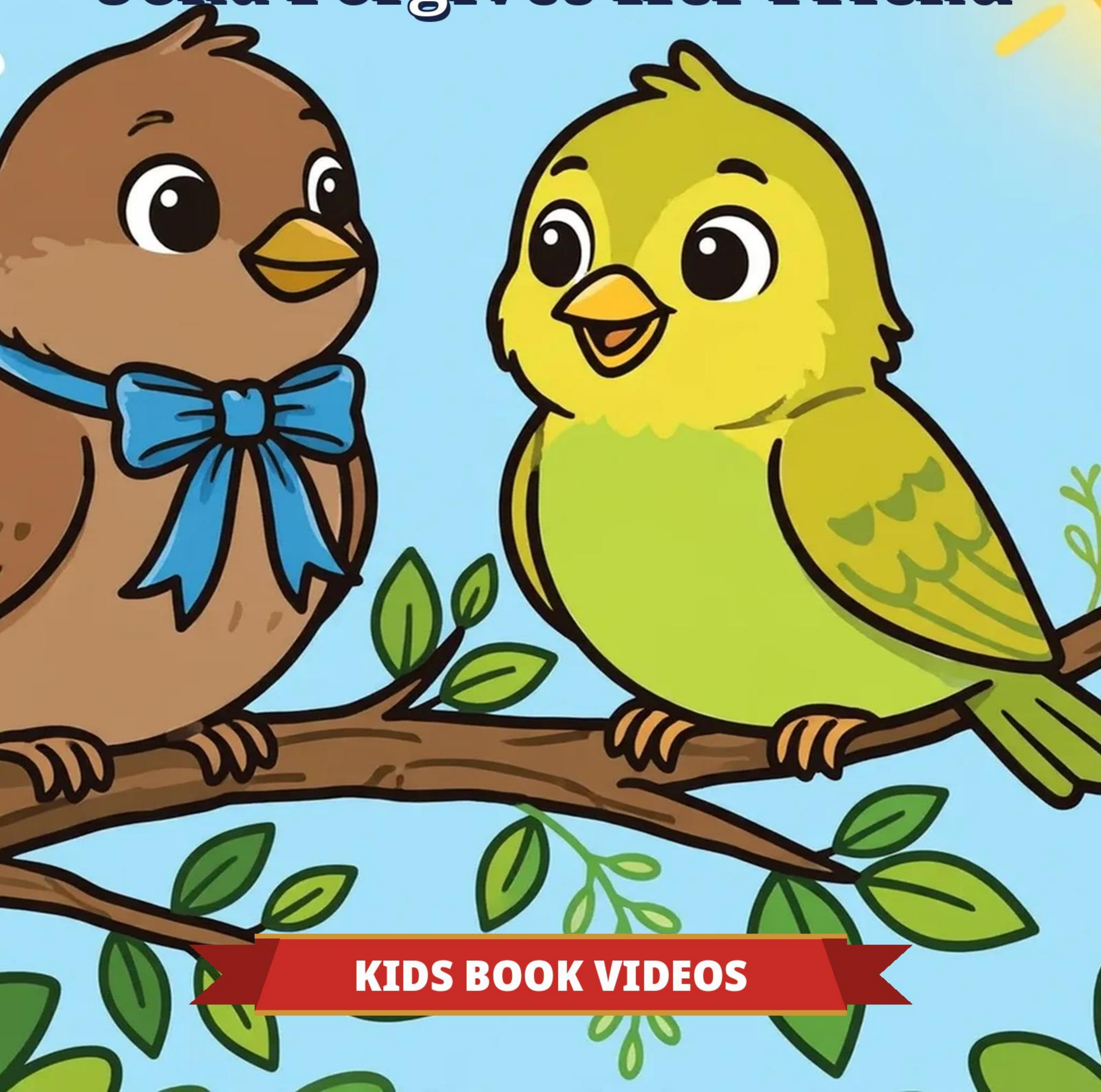


Bedtime Tales

Sona Forgives Her Friend



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



Sona was a little sparrow with a pretty blue ribbon — a gift from her grandma, and her most treasured thing in the whole world.

One day she lent it to her friend Tuli. "Please be careful with it," Sona chirped.

The next day, Tuli came back with her head hung low and her voice coming out small. "Sona, I lost your ribbon," she whispered. "The wind took it."



Sona's chest went tight. Her eyes burned hot. "That was my favorite ribbon!" she cried.

Tuli looked very sorry. "I am really sorry," she whispered.



Sona flew to her nest in the Old Apple Tree of Willowmere Wood and sat alone, with anger and sadness tangled up inside her. Mama Sparrow fluttered down beside her.

"I can see you're upset," Mama said gently. Sona nodded.



"It is okay to feel upset," Mama said. "Losing something special hurts."

Then Mama told her something wise. "Forgiving sets two hearts free."



She said it again, softer. "Forgiving sets two hearts free."

And once more, like a lullaby. "Forgiving sets two hearts free."



Sona thought about Tuli. Her friend had said sorry — and she felt bad too.

Sona took a deep breath and flew back to Tuli. "I forgive you," she said softly. "It was an accident."



Tuli's eyes shone. "Thank you, Sona," she said. "You are the best friend."

They hugged with their little wings. Sona felt the tight knot in her chest melt away. Her heart felt light and warm. Forgiving felt good.



That evening, they played together. They chased falling leaves and sang little songs. They were friends again — true friends.

At bedtime, Sona snuggled into her nest. The upset of the afternoon had melted into something soft and peaceful. Mama kissed her head.



"Forgiving was very brave," she said.

The night breeze rocked the Old Apple Tree. Sway, sway, hush.
Sona closed her eyes.



She was kind, and she was loved.

Sleep now, little Sona.

Sleep now, little Sona.

The End

